



EDVARD AND NINA GRIEG

The couple—shown here in front of one of Edvard's pianos—married in 1867. Nina, a soprano singer, became one of the main interpreters of her husband's work.

Literary collaborations

In the 1870s, Grieg began working with Norwegian writers. There were abortive attempts to produce an opera with Bjørnstjerne Bjørnson, but his association with Henrik Ibsen proved far more fruitful (see [box](#)). Grieg produced incidental music for Ibsen's extraordinary play *Peer Gynt*, which was loosely based on a fairy tale. His 90-minute score was used when the play was successfully staged in 1876. Grieg subsequently extracted eight movements from it, to form two orchestral suites (Op. 46 and Op. 55), which were added to his own concert repertoire. Including such pieces as *Morning Mood* and *In the*